

PENSIONS BOARD 28 JANUARY 2026



Report title: Lambeth Pensions Administration – Performance report for the period October 2025 to December 2025

Wards: All

Portfolio: Cabinet Member for Finance (Acting): Councillor Judith Cavanagh

Report Authorised by: Zena Cooke: Corporate Director of Resources

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REPORT SUMMARY

This is a performance report for the Lambeth Local Pension Board as part of their remit in assisting the Council to oversee the administration of the Lambeth Pension Fund. The report includes performance against the agreed performance indicators, administrative updates, developments and projects.

FINANCE SUMMARY

There are no financial implications arising from the recommendations in this report.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. To note the Pension Administration Service Performance update covering October 2025 to December 2025.
2. To report any comments or recommendations to the Pensions Committee.

1. CONTEXT

- 1.1 This report provides information on the performance of the Lambeth Pensions Administration Service (Lambeth Pensions) in relation to all its Scheme members (active, deferred and pensioner members).
- 1.2 The Lambeth Local Pension Board (Pension Board) is required to assist the Council in ensuring the effective and efficient governance and administration of the Lambeth Pension Fund for Local Government Pension Scheme (LGPS) members through the monitoring of Fund performance and adherence to statutory duties.

2. PROPOSAL AND REASONS

Membership Data

- 2.1 The total membership size of the Scheme cohort as of 31 December 2025 was 22,254. The table in Appendix One sets out the changes in the membership over previous quarters.

Key Performance Indicators

- 2.2 Lambeth Pensions measures the work processed using standard key performance indicators. The total number of cases completed on the pensions software system (Altair) in this quarter was 1,821. Cases for completion are aligned to the targets as set out within the Annual Report guidance jointly produced by the LGPS Scheme Advisory Board, the Chartered Institute of Public Finance and Accountancy (CIPFA) and the Ministry of Housing, Communities and Local Government (MHCLG). Statistics on the key performance indicators can be found in Appendix One.

Communications

2.3 Member Engagement

- **Active Member Communication:** Lambeth Pensions shares concise monthly updates on pension-related matters with Lambeth employees through the Viva Engage platform and the Employee Hub. This quarter's updates covered topics such as redundancy and flexible retirement options for members.
- **Planning for Retirement Courses:**
A series of retirement planning courses for Lambeth employees, including Lambeth schools, has been scheduled for this autumn to support members in preparing for retirement. Due to popular demand, additional courses will be arranged throughout 2026.

- 2.4 **Employer engagement:** Lambeth Pension Fund academies were notified of the Department for Education (DFE) online session on the 2025 valuation for academies. Representatives from administering authorities and actuaries provided a breakdown of the valuation process, shared key insights and answered questions from the attendees. A recording of the session is available on [YouTube](#).

- 2.5 **‘Engage’ – Member Self Service:** The ‘Engage’ platform offers an improved online self-service experience for members of the Scheme. To enhance security, multi-factor authentication (MFA) has been introduced, ensuring safer access to personal pension information. The platform also strengthens digital communication, allowing secure messaging to members directly through the portal.
- 2.6 There are currently 7,083 registered users. The team encourages all Scheme members to use Engage and links to the site are provided in emails and other communications. Registered user statistics are shown in Appendix One.
- 2.7 **Lambeth Pension Fund website:** The Lambeth Pension Fund website holds general information about the LGPS in addition to specific information pertaining to the Lambeth Pension Fund, for example:
- Information about the running of the Lambeth Pension Fund (e.g. who the Pensions Board and Pension Committee members are).
 - Scheme guides, forms and member newsletters.
 - the latest valuation report and annual report.
 - various pension fund policies (e.g. Communications Policy).
- 2.8 The following documents were refreshed/added this quarter:
- Lambeth Pension Fund Draft Annual Report 2024/25.
 - Transparency and Open Data section that provides information on the Fund’s investment performance.

Breaches of the law

- 2.9 Under the Pension Regulator’s Code of Practice, which covers the governance and administration of public service pension schemes, there is a requirement for Funds to report on breaches of the law. For the LGPS, a breach occurs if there is a failure to do anything required under the LGPS Regulations or overriding legislation, this includes providing incorrect information.
- 2.10 The breaches log in Appendix One details the current breaches for this period in addition to those remaining open from a previous period. The Lambeth Pension Fund Policy for Reporting Breaches of the Law can be found on the Fund’s website.
- 2.11 There were four breaches reported this quarter relating to the late submission of the monthly contributions schedule and/or payment from three employers of the Fund.

Complaints and compliments

- 2.12 There was one complaint and two compliments during this period. (Shown in Appendix One).

Internal Dispute Resolution Procedure

- 2.13 The LGPS regulations makes provision for a Scheme member who is not satisfied with any decision made about their benefits (or a failure to make a decision) to have their

complaint reviewed under the Scheme's Internal Disputes Resolutions Procedure (IDRP).

2.14 There are two formal stages in the IDRP process;

Stage One: An adjudicator is appointed to consider and reach a decision in relation to the Scheme member's complaint. Lambeth Council's adjudicator for a first stage appeal is the Director of Human Resources and Organisational Development.

Stage Two: If the Scheme member remains dissatisfied with the adjudicator's decision or their failure to make a decision, the Scheme member can apply to the administering authority to have it reconsidered. Second stage appeals are currently considered by the Director of Legal and Governance.

2.15 There were two stage one appeals and one stage two appeal this quarter. (Shown in Appendix One).

Risk register

2.16 The risk register was reviewed this quarter. Details are provided in a separate report.

Pensions opt out rate analysis

2.17 Lambeth Pensions continues to monitor the number of members opting out or moving to the 50/50 section of the Scheme. The most recent data available, as at November 2025, is shown in Appendix One. The higher opt out totals in 2025/26 reflects the pensions automatic enrolment process carried out in April 2025 during which 289 Lambeth employees were automatically enrolled into the LGPS.

Progress update on McCloud Remedy Implementation

2.18 During this quarter, we have undertaken a review of our internal membership records, focusing on cases where members hold multiple records. The objective is to ensure that McCloud protections are correctly applied to all relevant records, while also addressing any outstanding aggregations in line with regulatory requirements.

2.19 To date, we have reviewed approximately 60% of the 1,950 members identified with multiple records and, as a result, have confirmed an additional 161 members who fall within scope for protections. This work is expected to continue through to the end of the current financial year.

2.20 Looking ahead to the next financial year, we will begin examining the National Insurance Database to identify members with benefits in other LGPS funds who may qualify for protection. This will require us to gather additional data from those funds, supported by the use of the standard template provided by the Local Government Association (LGA).

Pensions Dashboard Update

- 2.21 As previously reported, we connected to the live dashboard infrastructure ahead of our scheduled staging date of 31 October 2025. We continue to upload member data regularly and monitor reports to respond to any “find” requests generated during national testing. A pensions dashboard “find” request is when someone uses the dashboard to locate all their pension pots. When they initiate this request, their identity details are securely shared with pension providers, who then search their records to identify and match any pensions linked to that individual. To date, we have not received any full or partial matches, though we anticipate this will change as testing expands.
- 2.22 The Dashboard Availability Point (DAP), the date when dashboards will become publicly accessible, has not yet been confirmed. However, schemes will receive six months’ notice once the date is agreed.
- 2.23 In recent weeks, we have initiated a one-off data cleansing and enrichment project to address the significant number of deferred members with “gone away” addresses. This work, carried out using a third party software, will verify and update contact details, fill gaps in missing information, and perform mortality screening. These steps will help ensure our data is accurate and complete in readiness for public dashboard access.
- 2.24 Additionally, we have established arrangements with our three Additional Voluntary Contributions (AVC) providers to receive regular data feeds. This will enable us to display AVC values for applicable members via the single source route.

LGPS ‘Access and protections’ consultation launched

- 2.25 On 13 October 2025, the Ministry of Housing Communities and Local Government launched a consultation on changes to the LGPS in England and Wales. The consultation focuses on Scheme access and benefits covering four key areas:
- Increasing the normal minimum pension age (NMPA) to 57 from April 2028.
 - Reinstating LGPS access for mayors and councillors.
 - Allowing multi-academy trusts to consolidate their schools under a single Pension Fund, rather than each school participating in its local Fund.
 - Extending Fair Deal protections to maintain LGPS access for outsourced workers.
- 2.26 The consultation closed on 22 December 2025. The Lambeth Pension Fund response is shown in Appendix Two.

3. FINANCE

- 3.1 There are no additional financial implications in relation to the items mentioned in this report.

4. LEGAL AND DEMOCRACY

- 4.1 The Lambeth Pension Fund is run in accordance with the Local Government Pension Scheme Regulations 2013 enacted along with other Regulations under the Superannuation Act 1972 and the Public Service Pension Act 2013 and is for the benefit of Council employees and outside organisations which have entered into an agreement with

Lambeth to provide pensions for their staff.

4.2 The Pension Board and Committee must be mindful of the Council's fiduciary duty to obtain the best possible financial return on the investments.

4.3 There are no additional comments from Democratic Services.

5. CONSULTATION AND CO-PRODUCTION

5.1 Where possible Lambeth Pensions shares ideas and working practices with other pension funds.

6. RISK MANAGEMENT

6.1 Action has been taken to mitigate any risks in relation to the items mentioned in this report. The Risk Register highlights the appropriate control measures to mitigate potential risks.

6.2 Refer to the Lambeth Pension Fund Risk Register.

7. EQUALITIES IMPACT ASSESSMENT

7.1 None for the purposes of this report.

8. COMMUNITY SAFETY

8.1 None for the purposes of this report.

9. CHILD FRIENDLY LAMBETH

9.1 Not applicable.

10. ORGANISATIONAL IMPLICATIONS

Environmental

10.1 Not applicable.

Health

10.2 Not applicable.

Staffing and accommodation

10.3 Not applicable.

Responsible Procurement

10.4 Not applicable.

11. TIMETABLE FOR IMPLEMENTATION

11.1 Not applicable.

AUDIT TRAIL				
Name/Position	Lambeth directorate/ division or partner	Date Sent	Date Received	Comments in para:
Zena Cooke, Corporate Director of Resources	Resources	07.01.2026	15.01.2026	
Jacqueline Moylan, Interim Director of Finance	Resources	07.01.2026	12.01.2026	
Andrew Pavlou, Principal Lawyer - Governance	Resources	07.01.2026	08.01.2026	
Vanisha Mistry, Democratic Services Officer	Resources	07.01.2026	12.02.2026	

REPORT HISTORY

Report History	
Original discussion with Cabinet Member	N/A
Report deadline	15.01.2026 (final report)
Date final report sent	15.01.2026
Part II Exempt from Disclosure/confidential accompanying report?	N/A
Key decision report	No
Date first appeared on forward plan	N/A
Key decision reasons	N/A
Background information	Performance Report July – September 2025 Lambeth Pension Fund Website Lambeth Pension Fund Draft Annual Report 2024/25 Transparency and Open Date – Investment Performance DFE online session for academies – Valuation 2025
Appendices	Appendix One – Pensions Admin Performance October – December 2025